



MCS School Board President Jim Williams addresses SEL & CRT at 9/28/21 Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fW3v_xepjo0
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Target Category	mcs

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Meeting: Muncie Community Schools Board

Document Analyzed: Municipal Meeting Transcript

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(Not applicable. Omitted pursuant to structural guidelines.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer opened the meeting [00:00:02](#) addressing pandemic challenges, economic issues, and political division affecting schools, while referencing the historic partnership between Ball State University and Muncie Community Schools created by House Enrolled Act 1315 (passed in May 2018).
- **Attendance:** Specific roll call of members present or absent was not explicitly read into the transcribed record, though the presiding officer and administrative staff (such as Mrs. Snyder) were noted as participating.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** None explicitly recorded in the transcript text.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** 00:00:02 A motion to approve the prior minutes was made and seconded, then approved by voice vote.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

Note: The transcript primarily consists of an extended comprehensive address by the presiding officer regarding district vision, curriculum philosophy, Social Emotional Learning (SEL), and the scope of social studies/English language arts instruction in response to public inquiries.

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:00:12 Comprehensive Presentation and Board Position on Social Emotional Learning (SEL) and Social Studies/History Curricula.
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presiding Officer / Board Leadership (with references to staff member Mrs. Snyder).
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - **Social Emotional Learning (SEL):** The board addressed public questions regarding SEL, clarifying that Muncie Community Schools utilizes the "Second Step" curriculum (recognized as an exemplary program in 2001). SEL promotes whole child development<U+2014>teaching self-regulation, persistence, empathy, self-awareness, and mindfulness<U+2014>to assist students dealing with trauma, adverse childhood experiences, and economic uncertainty.
 - **Critical Race Theory (CRT) vs. Culturally Responsive Learning:** The board distinguished between Critical Race Theory (noted as an academic framework originating from legal studies in the late 1960s/1970s and Derek Bell<U+2019>s interest-convergence theory, primarily suited for law/college levels) and the district's K-12 approach. The district emphasizes a diverse educational experience using primary sources that honestly confronts historical realities (slavery, the Civil War, Jim Crow, the civil rights movement) without teaching CRT.
 - **Curriculum Scope:** The board outlined a chronological framework of key historical figures, documents, and events that can and should be studied, ranging from the Declaration of Independence, the U.S. Constitution, and the Northwest Ordinance to the Civil Rights movement, industrialization, and major literary and cultural milestones.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None recorded directly during this portion of the transcript.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation and statement of board policy; no formal binding resolution or vote was taken on this item.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

Note: The transcript concludes immediately following the board presentation and the transition to the consent agenda; no open floor citizen forum was recorded in the text.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** 00:33:34 The presiding officer transitioned the meeting to the consent agenda ("we're on to our consent agenda... you have those").
 - **Adjournment:** The transcript concludes prior to the official adjournment of the meeting.
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